

VARRA AETERNA

A Rhovian Sourcebook for the World of Avara

10 Subclasses · 3 Playable Races · 7 Backgrounds · 10 Magic Items · 8 Feats



SETTING NOTE — RHOVUM IN AVARA

Throughout this document, the Roman-analog civilization of Avara is called **Rhovum**. Its people are **Rhovian**. These terms replace 'Rome' and 'Roman' in all content.

Balvor is the Avara name for the god of war, conquest, and the disciplined advance of armies. The Rhovians call him **Mars** — their name for the same deity. All references to Mars refer to Balvor.

Emperor Naeron was the last divine emperor of Rhovum. In his descent into madness, he swore himself to a devil who shared a corrupted form of his own name — **Nero**, a figure of flame, excess, and consuming authority. The Oath of the Burning Throne is sworn to Naeron's deified memory and to Balvor — but Naeron's divinity is tainted by Nero's influence. You are not worshipping a god. You are worshipping a man who borrowed his divinity from a devil, and the devil is still in there.

ROGUE — ROGUISH ARCHETYPE

The Sicarius

Varra Aeterna · Rhovian Subclasses

"The Sicarii did not kill in shadows. They killed at noon, in the forum, surrounded by witnesses who saw nothing."

The Sicarii were real. In the volatile decades of the late Rhovian Republic, they moved through forums, temples, and markets with curved blades — *sicae* — hidden beneath their cloaks. They struck officials in broad daylight, then folded back into the crowd before the body finished falling.

A Sicarius does not wait for the moment when everyone looks away. They *are* the moment everyone looks away — a familiar face, a concealed blade, and the half-second of inattention that is all a trained assassin ever needs.



ROGUE LEVEL	FEATURE
3rd	The Sica, Mark of the Eagle
9th	Leap of Faith
13th	Brotherhood
17th	Assassin of the Forum

3RD-LEVEL SICARIUS FEATURE

The Sica

The blade was made to disappear until the moment it was needed.

The *sica* is a short curved blade (dagger: light, finesse, 1d4 piercing) with three special properties.

Concealable. Conceal as a bonus action. Detecting it requires a Perception check contested by your Sleight of Hand, even while being searched.

Instant Draw. Drawing or stowing costs no action.

Unseen Edge. When you attack with a concealed sica against a creature that hasn't seen you draw it — first round of combat, while disguised, or while violence isn't expected — apply Sneak Attack without an adjacent ally or advantage. Cannot use if you have disadvantage. Resets when the target loses sight of you after you re-conceal as a bonus action.

3RD-LEVEL SICARIUS FEATURE

Mark of the Eagle

You read posture, breath, and the direction of a gaze.

Bonus action. Mark one creature within 60 feet. One mark active at a time, lasts 1 hour.

Tracked. You always know the marked target's exact location within 120 feet — ignores invisibility and hiding.

Read. Advantage on Insight and Perception checks against the marked target.

Marked for Death. When you deal Sneak Attack to the marked target, deal an additional **1d6 piercing damage**.

9TH-LEVEL SICARIUS FEATURE

Leap of Faith

The drop that kills other people is the Sicarius's exit route.

Unbroken Fall. Ignore all damage from falls of 60 feet or fewer.

Diving Strike. When you fall 15+ feet as part of movement and land within 5 feet of a creature, make one melee attack against them as a free action.

Vanishing Landing. Landing in a space with half cover (crowd of 3+, dense foliage, deep water, soft material) — immediately attempt to Hide even if observed before the fall.

13TH-LEVEL SICARIUS FEATURE

Brotherhood

Across the city, trained killers owe you their loyalty. When you signal, they answer.

Once per long rest, bonus action. Choose a creature affected by your Mark of the Eagle within 60 feet. A Brotherhood assassin strikes: that creature makes a DEX save (DC = 8 + proficiency bonus + DEX modifier). Fail: Sneak Attack dice in piercing damage. Success: half. Does not consume your Sneak Attack for the turn.

17TH-LEVEL SICARIUS FEATURE

Assassin of the Forum

You do not blend into the crowd. You are the crowd.

Ghost in the Crowd. While 3+ non-hostile creatures are within 20 feet, use Cunning Action to Hide even without cover, even while observed. Outside combat: only 1 non-hostile creature required.

Perfect Strike. When you use Unseen Edge and hit, you may maximize your Sneak Attack dice rather than rolling them.

Circle of the Genius Loci

Varra Aeterna · Rhovian Subclasses

"The grove does not patch wounds. It grows them closed."

The Rhovians understood that sacred places are not merely locations — they are presences. Every grove, spring, and crossroads had its *genius loci*: the spirit of the place. A druid of this circle does not tend a grove. They become one, extending it outward into their companions. The forest does not stop healing when the druid turns away.



DRUID LEVEL	FEATURE
2nd	Bonus Spells, Living Grove (Root Seal, Grove's Mantle)
6th	Verdant Surge
10th	Genius Loci Form
14th	Genius Loci Manifest

BONUS SPELLS

DRUID LEVEL	SPELLS
3rd	Bless, Aid
5th	Aura of Vitality, Mass Healing Word
7th	Aura of Life, Death Ward
9th	Dawn, Raise Dead

2ND-LEVEL GENIUS LOCI FEATURE

Living Grove

The grove chooses who belongs to it. You are the mechanism of that choice.

At the end of a long rest, designate up to your **Wisdom modifier** creatures as **Grove-Bound**. Plant growth manifests painlessly on them. Lasts until next long rest.

Root Seal. When you cast a healing spell of 1st level or higher on a Grove-Bound creature, they gain a **Root Seal**: at the start of each of their turns, they regain HP equal to your Wisdom modifier, for a number of turns equal to the spell slot level used. Only one seal per creature; a new one replaces the old.

Grove's Mantle. When you cast a healing spell on a Grove-Bound creature, simultaneously grant a *different* Grove-Bound creature within 60 feet temporary HP equal to your Wisdom modifier. No additional action required.

6TH-LEVEL GENIUS LOCI FEATURE

Verdant Surge

The grove does not wait to be asked.

When a Grove-Bound creature within 60 feet takes damage, use your **reaction** to surge their growth: they gain temporary HP equal to your **Wisdom modifier + proficiency bonus**. If the damage was a melee attack, the attacker makes a STR save (DC = 8 + proficiency bonus + WIS modifier) or is **restrained** until end of their next turn. Uses: proficiency bonus per long rest.

10TH-LEVEL GENIUS LOCI FEATURE

Genius Loci Form

You shed the pretense of a body and become, for a time, the place itself.

When you use Wild Shape, you may instead enter **Genius Loci Form** (1 Wild Shape use). Lasts 10 minutes, ends if you choose to move.

Rooted. Cannot move willingly. Immune to forced movement and prone.

Concentrated. Advantage on CON saves to maintain concentration.

Eternal Bloom. Root Seals on Grove-Bound creatures within 60 feet do not tick down while you remain in form. Root Seals applied while the form is active heal **double** your Wisdom modifier per tick.

Full Mantle. Grove's Mantle applies to **all** Grove-Bound creatures within 60 feet simultaneously on every healing cast — not just one additional target.

14TH-LEVEL GENIUS LOCI FEATURE

Genius Loci Manifest

The grove will not let them fall.

Grove's Embrace. When a Grove-Bound creature within 60 feet drops to 0 HP, use your **reaction** to instantly restore them to **1 HP**. They do not fall unconscious. Uses: Wisdom modifier per long rest.

Bloom. Once per long rest, action — every Grove-Bound creature within 60 feet regains HP equal to your **druid level + Wisdom modifier**, gains temporary HP equal to **Wisdom modifier × 2**, and is affected by *Bless* for 1 minute (no concentration).

FIGHTER — MARTIAL ARCHETYPE

The Triumphator

Varra Aeterna · Rhovian Subclasses

"March into the fray. The banner calls them home."

The Rhovian triumph was a declaration: that the general who walked that road had bent the world to Rhovum's will. The Triumphator does not wait for the war to end to be celebrated. They throw their standard into the heart of the enemy line and charge toward it, dragging the battle's gravity with them.



FIGHTER LEVEL	FEATURE
3rd	The Vexillum, Dragon Strike
7th	Golden Aegis
10th	Triumphal March
15th	Relentless Advance
18th	Cataclysm

3RD-LEVEL TRIUMPHATOR FEATURE

The Vexillum

Your cohort battle standard — thrown into the ground as a tactical anchor.

Plant the Standard. Bonus action — hurl the Vexillum to an unoccupied space within 60 feet. While planted, allies within 10 feet gain **+1 to attack rolls** and **cannot be frightened**. Retrieve as a free object interaction when you enter its space. A hostile creature must use an action and succeed on a STR check (DC = 8 + proficiency bonus + STR modifier) to pull it out.

Advance on the Standard. Bonus action — move up to 30 feet directly toward the Vexillum without provoking opportunity attacks. Does not replace your regular movement.

3RD-LEVEL TRIUMPHATOR FEATURE

Dragon Strike

Once per turn, the charge becomes a weapon.

When you move at least 10 feet in a straight line before making a melee weapon attack, that attack deals **+1d8 damage** and the target makes a STR save (DC = 8 + proficiency bonus + STR modifier) or is **knocked prone**. Advancing on the Standard counts as your required movement.

7TH-LEVEL TRIUMPHATOR FEATURE

Golden Aegis

You raise your weapon and the line holds.

Bonus action. You gain temporary HP equal to **5 + your Fighter level**. Allies of your choice within 15 feet gain temporary HP equal to **5 + half your Fighter level**. Enemies within 15 feet make a STR save or have their speed reduced by 10 feet until the start of your next turn. Uses: proficiency bonus per long rest.

10TH-LEVEL TRIUMPHATOR FEATURE

Triumphal March

Victory in the moment feeds the next advance.

When you or an ally within 30 feet reduces an enemy to 0 HP, use your **reaction**: all allies within 30 feet gain temporary HP equal to your **proficiency bonus** and may immediately move up to 10 feet without provoking opportunity attacks. Uses: proficiency bonus per long rest.

15TH-LEVEL TRIUMPHATOR FEATURE

Relentless Advance

Every feature deepens. Nothing is replaced.

Dragon Strike: Line Assault. Dragon Strike now affects every creature in a 5-foot line between your start and your target. Each makes the STR save or is knocked prone.

Free Standard. Planting the Vexillum is now a free object interaction once per turn — no bonus action required.

Charge and Strike. When you Advance on the Standard, make one melee attack upon arriving within 5 feet of it as part of that bonus action. Qualifies for Dragon Strike automatically.

18TH-LEVEL TRIUMPHATOR FEATURE

Cataclysm

Once per long rest. Action. No one escapes.

Move up to 30 feet toward a creature you can see (no opportunity attacks). Upon reaching an adjacent space, a ring of palisades erupts in a **10-foot radius** around you and the target — 10 feet tall, impassable without flying or burrowing. Each 5-foot section has 20 HP, immunity to poison and psychic, resistance to nonmagical physical damage.

The target makes a STR save (DC = 8 + proficiency bonus + STR modifier) or is **stunned** until the end of your next turn. The palisades last 1 minute, until you fall unconscious, or until you end them (no action).

RANGER — RANGER ARCHETYPE

The Venator

Varra Aeterna · Rhovian Subclasses

"The kill is not the point. The performance is."

The *venatores* hunted exotic beasts in the Rhovian arena — lions from the south, bears from the Germanic forests, crocodiles from distant rivers. They fought with nets and spears and were expected not merely to kill but to do so with style. The crowd wanted a performance. A clean thrust was acceptable. A messy struggle was not.



RANGER LEVEL	FEATURE
3rd	Hunter's Net, Showkill
7th	Called Shot
11th	Trophy Capture
15th	Grand Venation

3RD-LEVEL VENATOR FEATURE

Hunter's Net

The standard net is a novelty. Yours is a threat.

Proficiency with nets and tridents. Your nets: **Range 15/30** (from 5/15). **Escape DC** = 8 + proficiency bonus + DEX modifier (from flat 10). You can throw a net as a **bonus action** once per turn (from action). Craft 1 net during a short rest; carry up to 3.

3RD-LEVEL VENATOR FEATURE

Showkill

The crowd demands a performance.

When you hit a creature that is **restrained**, **paralyzed**, or **grappled** with a weapon attack, deal extra damage:

RANGER LEVEL	EXTRA DAMAGE
3rd–6th	1d6 + Wisdom modifier
7th–10th	2d6 + Wisdom modifier
11th–14th	3d6 + Wisdom modifier
15th+	4d6 + Wisdom modifier

7TH-LEVEL VENATOR FEATURE

Called Shot

You place shots to control, not just to damage.

Once per turn when a ranged weapon attack hits, declare a Called Shot (no extra action). Choose one:

Hamstring: Target's speed halved until start of your next turn.

Disarm: STR save (DC 8 + proficiency bonus + DEX modifier) or drop one held item.

Suppress: Target cannot take reactions until start of your next turn.

Uses: Wisdom modifier per short rest.

11TH-LEVEL VENATOR FEATURE

Trophy Capture

A kill proves skill. A live capture proves mastery.

When you reduce a **Beast or Monstrosity** of CR no higher than your **proficiency bonus – 2** to 0 HP, you may spend 1 minute binding it. The creature becomes your **Captive** for 24 hours: acts on your initiative after your turn, obeys simple verbal commands, is friendly to you and your allies. After 24 hours it regains its normal disposition and leaves. One Captive at a time. Dealing damage to your Captive immediately makes it hostile.

15TH-LEVEL VENATOR FEATURE

Grand Venation

Once per long rest. Action. Every trap, every net, every called shot has been building toward this.

Make one ranged weapon attack with **advantage** against a target within normal range. On a hit: the attack deals **maximum damage**. The target makes a STR save (DC = 8 + proficiency bonus + DEX modifier) or is **restrained** for 1 minute — only a creature other than the target can spend an action to free them.

If the target was **already restrained**: they are instead **stunned** until end of your next turn and your Showkill dice are rolled **twice**.

On a miss: Grand Venation is **not expended**.

PALADIN — SACRED OATH

Oath of the Burning Throne

Varra Aeterna · Rhovian Subclasses

"I freeze them. I burn them. They cannot run."

Two patrons together describe the complete shape of imperial conquest. **Emperor Naeron** — the self-declared divine emperor, who in his descent into madness swore himself to a devil who shared a corrupted form of his own name, **Nero** — embodies authority made absolute. **Balvor**, called Mars by the Rhovians, embodies purposeful destruction: cities razed on policy, fields scorched on strategy. This oath is not broken. It was chosen.

TENETS OF THE BURNING THRONE

- I** *Conquer or submit.*
Everything before you has two fates. Decide which.
- II** *Fire is discipline made visible.*
Chaos burns recklessly. These flames are purposeful.
- III** *The Emperor's word is the war-god's action.*
Authority does not negotiate. It commands, and the fire follows.
- IV** *The throne burns, but it does not fall.*
You may consume everything around you. You may not break.

PALADIN LEVEL	FEATURE
3rd	Oath Spells, Conqueror's Smite, Channel Divinity
7th	Aura of Dominion
15th	Scorched Earth
20th	Avatar of Imperial Fire

OATH SPELLS

PALADIN LEVEL	SPELLS
3rd	Command, Burning Hands
5th	Hold Person, Scorching Ray
9th	Fear, Fireball
13th	Dominate Beast, Wall of Fire
17th	Dominate Person, Immolation

3RD-LEVEL BURNING THRONE FEATURE

Conqueror's Smite

The light of Balvor is not mercy. It is the fire of legions advancing.

Your **Divine Smite** deals **fire damage** instead of radiant. When you smite a creature that is **frightened**, **restrained**, or **paralyzed**, the smite deals **one additional fire damage die**.

3RD-LEVEL BURNING THRONE FEATURE

Channel Divinity

Two patrons. Two weapons.

Imperial Command. Action. Cast *Command* without a spell slot, targeting **all creatures of your choice within 30 feet** simultaneously. Same command word, individual saves. Creatures that fail are also **frightened of you** until end of their next turn.

Martian Conflagration. Action. Choose a point within 60 feet — a 10-foot radius, 40-foot tall column of sacred fire erupts there. DEX save (spell save DC): Fail = **3d8 fire + 3d8 radiant damage**; Success = half. Creatures that fail the DEX save also make a WIS save or are **frightened** until end of your next turn.

7TH-LEVEL BURNING THRONE FEATURE

Aura of Dominion

The flames know their own. They burn everything else.

While conscious, 10-foot aura (30 feet at 18th level):

For Allies: Resistance to fire damage. Cannot be frightened.

For Enemies: Hostile creatures starting their turn in the aura take fire damage equal to **Charisma modifier + proficiency bonus**. Hostile creatures **frightened of you** cannot willingly move while in the aura.

15TH-LEVEL BURNING THRONE FEATURE

Scorched Earth

The ground itself becomes a weapon.

Burning Ground. Once per short rest, action — a 20-foot radius zone erupts within 120 feet, 1 minute, **no concentration**: difficult terrain, 2d8 fire damage to hostile creatures starting their turn there, frightened creatures within cannot move or Dash.

Relentless Flame. Bonus action — move an active Burning Ground up to 30 feet to a new center within 120 feet. The fire follows your will.

20TH-LEVEL BURNING THRONE FEATURE

Avatar of Imperial Fire

Once per long rest. Action. 1 minute.

Immunity. Fire damage immunity.

Burning Strikes. Weapon attacks deal +2d6 fire damage.

Perfect Smite. All Divine Smite dice deal **maximum value**.

Imperial Aura. Aura damage **doubles** and applies even to creatures immune to the frightened condition.

Mass Terror. Hostile creatures starting their turn in the aura make a WIS save or are frightened until start of your next turn. Frightened creatures in the aura cannot take any action other than the **Attack action**.

Imperial Dominion. Once during the Avatar's duration, bonus action — one creature within 60 feet makes a WIS save or falls under *Dominate Monster* for the remainder of the Avatar. No concentration.

Varra Aeterna · Oath of the Burning Throne · Sacred Oath

SORCERER — SORCEROUS ORIGIN

Bloodline of the Lupa

Varra Aeterna · Rhovian Subclasses

"The she-wolf did not offer comfort. She offered survival."

The founding myth of Rhovum doesn't begin with gods or kings — it begins with an animal who made a choice. The Lupa sorcerer is a melee caster. Their spells are not thrown from a safe distance — they are delivered through a strike, pressed into flesh at the point of contact. The magic and the violence are the same thing.



SORCERER LEVEL	FEATURE
1st	Wolf's Blood
3rd	Lupa Metamagic
6th	Lupa's Fury
14th	Greater Spell Fang
18th	Lupa's Form

1ST-LEVEL LUPA FEATURE

Wolf's Blood

The bloodline sits just below the skin. It surfaces when you fight.

Natural Armor. AC = 13 + DEX modifier. No armor required.

Unarmed Strikes. 1d6 piercing. Use DEX for attack rolls. Add CHA modifier to damage.

Spell Fang. When you cast a Touch spell or a cantrip requiring a spell attack roll, deliver it through an unarmed strike. The strike roll replaces the spell attack roll. Hit: strike damage + spell effect both apply. Miss: both lost.

3RD-LEVEL LUPA FEATURE

Lupa Metamagic

The bloodline doesn't follow the rules other sorcerers were taught.

When you gain Metamagic, the following options are added to your available choices:

Rending Spell (2 SP). The spell ignores the target's resistance to its damage type. Immunity is treated as resistance.

Blood Price (2 SP). Cast the spell as if using a slot one level higher. You take 2d6 necrotic damage that cannot be prevented or reduced. Stackable.

Wolf's Instinct (1 SP). When a creature within 5 feet attacks you, spend 1 SP as a reaction to cast a cantrip against them before their attack resolves. A hit gives them disadvantage on the incoming attack.

6TH-LEVEL LUPA FEATURE

Lupa's Fury

Wolves don't take one bite.

Extra Attack. Attack twice when you take the Attack action. One attack per turn can be replaced with a Spell Fang delivery.

Pack Bond. While a creature is grappled by you, your Spell Fang attacks against it have advantage, and your allies' attacks against it have advantage.

Primal Survival. Once per long rest when damage would reduce you to 0 HP, spend 3 Sorcery Points as a reaction to drop to 1 HP instead. If you have no points, this triggers once for free.

14TH-LEVEL LUPA FEATURE

Greater Spell Fang

The jaw closes on something larger now.

Spell Fang works for **any spell requiring a single spell attack roll** — not only Touch spells and cantrips.

Unarmed strikes scale to **2d6 + CHA modifier**.

On a Spell Fang hit, target makes STR save (DC = spell save DC) or is **grappled** by you. Once per turn, no action required.

18TH-LEVEL LUPA FEATURE

Lupa's Form

Once per long rest. Bonus action. 1 minute. This is what the bloodline was building toward.

Gain **30 temporary hit points**.

Unarmed strikes scale to **3d6 + CHA modifier**.

You can cast a leveled spell as your action **and** make unarmed strikes as your bonus action in the same turn. Overrides the standard two-spells restriction.

Creatures that take damage from your spells or strikes make a WIS save (DC = spell save DC) or are **frightened** of you until the start of your next turn.

Varra Aeterna · Bloodline of the Lupa · Sorcerous Origin

Path of the Arena

Varra Aeterna · Rhovian Subclasses

"The Rhovian arena didn't produce soldiers. It produced performers who happened to kill people."

Gladiators trained in schools, each teaching a different philosophy of violence. The Retiarius used space and restraint. The Secutor pressed the advantage. The Murmillo broke through anything in front of them. You didn't pick a style because it suited your personality. You picked it because it was what you survived learning.



BARBARIAN LEVEL	FEATURE
3rd	Gladiatorial Stances, Blood Sport
6th	Crowd's Favor
10th	Veteran of the Sands
14th	Champion of the Arena

3RD-LEVEL ARENA FEATURE

Gladiatorial Stances

Choose your school when you enter Rage. Switch as a bonus action while raging.

Retiarius (Net & Trident). Reach extends 5 feet. On a hit, bonus action grapple attempt. Creatures grappled by you have speed reduced to 0.

Secutor (Sword & Shield). +2 AC while raging. Reaction when hit in melee: make one attack against the attacker. +1d6 damage on your first hit each turn.

Murmillo (Heavy Offensive). +1d6 damage on all attacks. Critical hits knock target prone. Cannot be grappled or restrained in this stance.

3RD-LEVEL ARENA FEATURE

Blood Sport

The crowd feeds you.

When you reduce a creature to 0 HP while raging, gain temporary HP equal to your **CON modifier + proficiency bonus**.

6TH-LEVEL ARENA FEATURE

Crowd's Favor

You've learned to make being hit look like a choice.

While raging, when you take damage, use your **reaction** to reduce it by your **proficiency bonus + CHA modifier**.

Once per rage when reduced to half HP or below: switch stances as a free action and regain HP equal to your **Barbarian level**.

10TH-LEVEL ARENA FEATURE

Veteran of the Sands

Every school opens up once you've bled enough to know how they really work.

Retiarius: Grapple on hit is automatic — no bonus action required.

Secutor: AC bonus increases to +3. Reaction attack is made with advantage.

Murmillo: Bonus damage increases to 2d6. Critical hits also **stun** the target until the end of their next turn.

14TH-LEVEL ARENA FEATURE

Champion of the Arena

Once per long rest while raging, 1 minute. The crowd stops breathing.

Damage that would drop you to 0 HP drops you to **1 HP** instead, once per turn.

Enemies within 30 feet have **disadvantage on attacks against anyone except you**.

When you drop a creature to 0 HP, all enemies within 30 feet make a WIS save (DC = 8 + proficiency bonus + CHA modifier) or are **frightened** until start of your next turn.

Domain of the Augur

Varra Aeterna · Rhovian Subclasses

"The Rhovians built nothing without reading the signs first."

Battles, marriages, trade routes — all consulted the omens. The augur's role was practical: someone had to read the world before the world acted. The fact that it worked is a separate question from why.



CLERIC LEVEL	FEATURE
1st	Augur's Eye
2nd	Channel Divinity: Read the Signs, Ill Omen
6th	Haruspex
8th	Divine Strike
17th	Seer of Fates

DOMAIN SPELLS

CLERIC LEVEL	SPELLS
3rd	Detect Magic, Augury
5th	Clairvoyance, Speak with Dead
7th	Arcane Eye, Divination
9th	Commune, Scrying

1ST-LEVEL AUGUR FEATURE

Augur's Eye

You read what other people walk past without seeing.

Add your **Wisdom modifier** to Initiative rolls.

During a short or long rest, spend 10 minutes performing augury. Learn one: approximate number of combat encounters ahead (none/few/many); whether any creature within 1 mile intends harm toward the party; or a vague symbolic vision of a significant threat (DM's discretion).

2ND-LEVEL AUGUR FEATURE

Channel Divinity

You saw this coming. You warned them.

Read the Signs. Action. For 10 minutes: cannot be surprised; know number and general direction of all creatures within 60 feet; once before it ends, use your reaction to give disadvantage to an incoming attack against you or an ally.

Ill Omen. Action. Mark one creature within 60 feet for 1 minute: disadvantage on saving throws; first critical hit becomes a normal hit; when it dies, perform an instant augury at no time cost.

6TH-LEVEL AUGUR FEATURE

Haruspex

Every death is legible if you know what to look for.

When a creature within 60 feet dies, use your **reaction**. Choose one: all allies within 30 feet gain advantage on their next attack roll; the next save any creature within 60 feet makes before end of your next turn has disadvantage; or you briefly glimpse one significant memory of the creature.

8TH-LEVEL AUGUR FEATURE

Divine Strike

You read death. You also deal it.

Once per turn when you hit with a weapon attack, deal an additional **1d8 necrotic damage** (increases to **2d8** at level 14).

17TH-LEVEL AUGUR FEATURE

Seer of Fates

You have read enough endings to know how to avoid yours.

Cast **Foresight** once per long rest without a spell slot.

Once per long rest, **automatically succeed** on one death saving throw.

You always know when a creature within 60 feet is actively concealing information or lying — not what the truth is, only that concealment is happening.

Tradition of the Lares

Varra Aeterna · Rhovian Subclasses

"The Lares don't live in a place. They live in your magic. Your territory is wherever your spells reach."

The Rhovians kept minor spirits — Lares — tied to the household and threshold. The Tradition of the Lares doesn't bind spirits to a building. It binds them to a practice. Cast a Web: the Lares flow in. Cast Hunger of Hadar: the Lares inhabit the dark. Your zone spells were already good. The Lares make them personal.



WIZARD LEVEL	FEATURE
2nd	Household Spirits, Living Territory
6th	Warded Boundary
10th	Penates
14th	Genius Loci

2ND-LEVEL LARES FEATURE

Household Spirits

The spirits have always been here. You've learned to invite them.

Find Familiar is always prepared and doesn't count against your prepared spells. Your familiars are **Lares** — translucent minor spirits taking any Tiny form. You can maintain a number of Lares equal to half your INT modifier rounded up (minimum 1).

2ND-LEVEL LARES FEATURE

Living Territory

Wherever a spell claims space, the Lares follow.

When you cast a spell that creates a persistent area of effect lasting at least 1 round, that area becomes your **Active Territory** for the spell's duration. One territory at a time — a new one ends the old.

While Active Territory exists: advantage on Perception and Investigation checks for creatures within it; **advantage on spell attack rolls** against creatures within it; hostile creatures within it have speed reduced by **10 feet**.

Always prepared (don't count against preparation): *Find Familiar*, *Alarm*, *Web*, *Slow*, *Evard's Black Tentacles*, *Hunger of Hadar*, *Entangle*.

6TH-LEVEL LARES FEATURE

Warded Boundary

The Lares know who belongs inside and who doesn't.

When you establish Active Territory, ward its perimeter as a bonus action. Choose one effect that triggers for the first creature to enter from outside: **Alarm Ward** (instantly know their location and appearance, including if invisible); **Repulsion Ward** (2d8 force damage, pushed 5 feet, STR save for half and no push); or **Binding Ward** (speed reduced to 0 until end of their next turn). One ward at a time.

Alarm is also always prepared and lasts permanently when cast outside this feature.

10TH-LEVEL LARES FEATURE

Penates

Your bond with the spirits has become something the uninvited can feel.

Once per short rest when you establish Active Territory, **Empower** it. While empowered: speed reduction increases to **20 feet**; hostile creatures starting their turn in the territory take **1d6 force damage**; your spell save DC increases by **2** within the territory; you can see through any Lar's eyes as a bonus action.

14TH-LEVEL LARES FEATURE

Genius Loci

You are more spirit than scholar now.

Protective Ancestor. Reaction when you or an ally within the territory takes damage — one Lar destroys itself, absorbing up to **3d10 + INT modifier** damage. The Lar reforms after 24 hours.

Banishment of the Unwelcome. Once per long rest, reaction when a hostile creature enters the territory — CHA save against your spell save DC or they are returned to the point they entered from and cannot willingly re-enter for **1 minute**.

The Divus

Varra Aeterna · Rhovian Subclasses

"Your patron was declared a god by a political body. Whether that declaration means anything is a question your power does not answer."

The Rhovians voted on whether dead emperors were divine. Most were. Your patron is a dead man whose divinity was decided by committee, whose miracles were written by loyal historians — and whose power flows to you regardless. The Divus grants authority: the specific, social, terrifying kind that makes a room go quiet and do what it's told.



WARLOCK LEVEL	FEATURE
1st	Expanded Spells, Edicts, Divine Presence
6th	Triumphal Authority
10th	Imperial Decree
14th	Apotheosis

EXPANDED SPELL LIST

SPELL LEVEL	SPELLS
1st	Command, Charm Person
2nd	Suggestion, Crown of Madness
3rd	Hypnotic Pattern, Fear
4th	Compulsion, Dominate Beast
5th	Dominate Person, Geas

1ST-LEVEL DIVUS FEATURE

Edicts + Divine Presence

The emperor's word is not a request.

Edicts. Once per short rest, cast *Command* without expending a spell slot.

Divine Presence. Creatures that fail a save against your spells have disadvantage on the first attack roll and saving throw they make before the start of your next turn.

6TH-LEVEL DIVUS FEATURE

Triumphal Authority

Emperors don't address individuals. They address rooms.

Crowd Control. When you cast a spell that charms or frightens a creature, affect one additional creature within range at no additional cost.

False Divinity. Once per long rest, action — 1 minute: appear divine to magical detection, advantage on Persuasion and Intimidation, creatures that fail a WIS save (DC = spell save DC) believe you are a deity until contradicted.

10TH-LEVEL DIVUS FEATURE

Imperial Decree

One command. Every room.

Edicts now targets **all creatures of your choice within 30 feet** simultaneously. Same command word, individual saves.

Divine Presence now applies to **all saving throws** a creature makes before the start of your next turn — not just the first.

14TH-LEVEL DIVUS FEATURE

Apotheosis

Whether your patron is truly divine stops mattering when you are.

Acclaim. While you maintain a charm or fear effect on a creature, they are Acclaimed — if an attack would hit you and an Acclaimed creature is within 5 feet of the attacker, the Acclaimed creature interposes and takes the damage instead.

The Deification. Once per long rest, action, 1 minute: float 5 feet off the ground; charm and compel spells auto-succeed against creatures of CR ≤ half your warlock level; heal for half the damage any creature within 60 feet takes; immune to being charmed, frightened, or compelled.

Eldritch Invocations for The Divus

Tribune's Voice (5th level): Edicts usable twice per short rest. // Bread and Circuses: Exclude CHA modifier creatures from area spells. // Praetorian Guard: Cast Shield once per short rest without a slot. // Voice of the Mob (requires Eldritch Blast): EB pushes 10 ft and deafens. // Lapidary of the Divine (9th level): Glyph of Warding once per long rest, no slot. // Triumphal Procession: Creatures that failed saves against you recently cannot take opportunity attacks against you. // Immortal Reputation: Disguise Self at will as an idealized luminous version of yourself.

Supporting Systems

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Each subclass in this collection has additional mechanical support that extends its identity — custom fighting styles, Hunter's Mark variants, Lay on Hands options, and additional metamagic. These features are unlocked through specific subclass choices, not through general class progression.



TRIUMPHATOR — CUSTOM FIGHTING STYLE

Formation Fighting. While at least one ally is within 5 feet of you, gain +1 AC and advantage on saving throws against being frightened. You are not a lone warrior. You are a line.

VENATOR — HUNTER'S MARK VARIANT

When you apply Hunter's Mark, the marked target also cannot benefit from the Disengage action. You've identified the prey. They don't get to run cleanly.

BURNING THRONE — LAY ON HANDS VARIANT

The Burning Throne paladin's Lay on Hands pool can be spent two ways:

Restore. Standard healing — 1 HP per point spent.

Ignite (10 points). Bonus action. One creature within 30 feet takes 3d6 fire damage and is set ablaze — 1d6 fire at the start of each of their turns until extinguished.

LAES — ALWAYS PREPARED SPELLS

The following spells are always prepared for the Laes wizard and do not count against prepared spell totals: *Find Familiar*, *Alarm*, *Web*, *Slow*, *Evard's Black Tentacles*, *Hunger of Hadar*, *Entangle*. Each creates an area the Laes can inhabit.

PLAYABLE RACES

Medusa • Lemure • Faun

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These three races are native to Avara and shaped by Rhovian mythology — each one a creature the Rhovians named, feared, or claimed as part of their founding stories.



MEDUSA

They appear almost human at a distance. Up close, the hair moves.

+2 CHA, +1 CON (or +2/+1 anywhere) • Humanoid • Medium • Speed 30 ft • Darkvision 60 ft

Languages: Common plus one of Rhovian tongue, Elven, or Infernal

Serpentine Hair

A natural melee weapon you've had since birth.

Hair Strike: 1d4 piercing + 1d4 poison. Proficient with this attack. On a hit, target makes CON save (DC 8 + PB + CHA mod) or has disadvantage on their next attack roll.

Petrifying Gaze

You choose who the gaze affects.

Action or bonus action. One creature within 30 feet makes CON save (DC 8 + PB + CHA mod). Fail: restrained until end of your next turn. Success: immune to your gaze for 24 hours. Once per short rest.

Poison Resistance

Resistance to poison damage. Advantage on saves against the poisoned condition.

LEMURE

You are not a ghost — you are a person the underworld still has an unfinished claim on.

+2 WIS, +1 CON (or +2/+1 anywhere) • Humanoid • Medium • Speed 30 ft • Darkvision 60 ft

Languages: Common plus one of your choice

Between Worlds

The underworld's claim keeps you fed and breathing — or close enough.

No need to eat, drink, or breathe. Advantage on death saving throws. Resistance to necrotic damage.

Shadow Step

The dark isn't an obstacle. It's a doorway.

While in dim light or darkness, bonus action: teleport up to 30 feet to an unoccupied space you can see also in dim light or darkness. Once per short rest.

Haunting Presence

Once per long rest, bonus action — drop the pretense of normalcy.

Every creature within 30 feet that can see you makes WIS save (DC 8 + PB + WIS mod) or is frightened until end of your next turn.

Sense the Restless

You always know where the dying are.

Always know the direction of the nearest creature at 0 HP and nearest undead within 300 feet. Direction only — not identity.

FAUN

You've been in this forest longer than Rhovum has existed, and you find human cities entertaining the way a wolf finds a sheep pen entertaining.

+2 CHA, +1 WIS (or +2/+1 anywhere) · Humanoid · Medium · Speed 35 ft (hooves) · No darkvision

Languages: Common plus Sylvan

Ram Charge

The horns aren't decorative.

If you move 20+ feet in a straight line toward a creature and hit with an unarmed strike, deal +2d6 bludgeoning. Target makes STR save (DC 8 + PB + STR mod) or is knocked prone.

Natural Pipes

The sound Faunus taught you was never meant to be calming.

Once each per long rest, no spell slot, using CHA as spellcasting ability: Enthrall, Dissonant Whispers, Speak with Animals.

Panic of Faunus

Once per long rest, bonus action.

Every creature within 30 feet that can hear you makes WIS save (DC 8 + PB + CHA mod) or is frightened until end of your next turn. Frightened creatures must flee.

Child of the Wild

Difficult terrain from natural sources never slows you. Cannot be surprised outdoors in a natural environment.

BACKGROUNDS

Seven Rhovian Origins

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Miles Emeritus

Legionary Veteran

The legion gave you discipline, scars, and a way of reading strangers that has nothing to do with kindness.

Skills: Athletics, Intimidation · **Tool:** Land Vehicles · **Languages:** One of your choice

Equipment: A battered shield bearing a faded unit insignia, traveler's clothes, a letter of honorable discharge, 15 gp

Feature — The Eagle's Shadow. Military personnel, veterans, and soldiers of Rhovian-aligned factions grant you basic hospitality and share local military intelligence without requiring explanation.

Liber Harenae

Arena Survivor

You're out now. Mostly.

Skills: Performance, Athletics · **Tool:** One gaming set · **Languages:** One exotic language from a fellow fighter

Equipment: A gladiator's practice weapon, a leather cord with a betting token someone once wagered on you, 10 gp

Feature — Reading the Crowd. After 1 minute observing a group of 20+ people, you know their general mood and what kind of display would shift it.

Discipulus Haruspicus

Haruspex's Apprentice

Your master is dead or gone. You kept the knowledge and the habit of watching everything.

Skills: Insight, Religion · **Tool:** Herbalism kit · **Languages:** One of your choice

Equipment: Small bone reading tools, a journal of omen-records, robes, 8 gp

Feature — Signs and Portents. After 10 minutes observing an environment before entering a new location, ask the DM one yes/no question about what the party is about to face. Honest but may be symbolic.

Natus Senatoris

Senator's Child

You grew up watching your father end careers with a sentence. You know how Rhovian power actually works.

Skills: History, Persuasion · **Tool:** Calligrapher's supplies · **Languages:** One of your choice

Equipment: Fine clothes, a family signet ring, a letter of introduction, 25 gp

Feature — Inherited Name. Your family name carries weight in any settlement with Rhovian political presence. Officials see you within 24 hours. Merchants offer 10% discounts.

Liberti Freed Person

You were property once. The world didn't change — just your legal category in it.

Skills: Deception, Sleight of Hand · **Tool:** Forgery kit · **Languages:** One of your choice

Equipment: Papers of manumission, nondescript clothing for multiple social contexts, 12 gp

Feature — Between Worlds. You pass as a servant in noble spaces and as staff in official ones without being questioned unless someone actively investigates. Advantage on Deception checks to maintain false social status.

Peregrinus Conquered Person

You come from somewhere Rhovum marched through — you learned their language, their customs, and exactly what to hide.

Skills: Insight, Stealth · **Tool:** One artisan's tool from your homeland · **Languages:** Rhovian tongue plus one homeland language

Equipment: A memento from before the conquest, traveler's clothes, 10 gp

Feature — Neither Here Nor There. You move through Rhovian settlements without being documented or remarked upon. Once per settlement, find the network of other conquered peoples — they share what they know without requiring your name.

Vaela Sibyllae Sibyl's Chosen

You were given to the sacred fire as a child. The fire gave you something back.

Skills: Religion, Insight · **Tool:** Calligrapher's supplies · **Languages:** Two of your choice

Equipment: White robes, a clay tablet inscribed with an omen only you understand, 10 gp

Feature — Keeper of the Flame. Standing access to any temple or sacred site in Rhovian-aligned settlements. Once per long rest, request sanctuary — no Rhovian-aligned religious institution will permit violence on its grounds while you are within it.

Rhovian Artifacts & Martial Traditions

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MAGIC ITEMS

Pilum of the Legion

Rare · Weapon (Javelin)

Engineered to bend on impact, fouling enemy shields.

- +1 to attack and damage. Range 30/120.
- On a hit against a creature with a shield, that shield's AC bonus is reduced to 0 until start of their next turn.

Aquila Standard

Rare · Wondrous Item

The golden eagle of Rhovum has never touched the ground.

- Allies within 30 feet who can see it cannot be frightened.
- Help action while carrying: target gains advantage on their next three rolls instead of one.
- Once per long rest, action — hostile creatures within 30 feet make WIS save (DC 15) or are frightened for 1 minute.

Laurel Crown of Triumph

Uncommon · Wondrous (requires attunement)

They put this on your head after the last battle.

- When you reduce a creature to 0 HP, gain 1d6 temporary HP.
- Once per long rest, cast Heroism on yourself without a spell slot.

Gladius of the Tribune

Uncommon · Weapon (Shortsword)

The blade rewards precision over power.

- +1 to attack and damage.
- When you deal Sneak Attack damage, you can maximize one Sneak Attack die rather than rolling it.

Ring of the Augur

Uncommon · Ring (requires attunement)

You stopped ignoring what the birds were doing.

- Advantage on Insight checks.

- Once per long rest, cast Augury without components or a spell slot.
- On a natural 20 Insight check, learn the target's surface thoughts for 1 round.

Pugio of the Sicarii

Rare · Weapon (Dagger)

They never found the weapon because nobody saw it drawn.

- +1 to attack and damage.
- Bonus action: blade becomes invisible for up to 1 hour — DC 18 Perception to notice you are armed.
- Attacks against a creature that has not yet taken a turn in combat deal +2d6 piercing damage.

Amphora of Balvor

Rare · Wondrous Item

Seven charges, regains 1d4+2 at dawn. Called the Amphora of Mars by the Rhovians — same item.

- 1 charge: Burning Hands. 3 charges: Fireball. 5 charges: Wall of Fire.
- When the last charge is spent, roll a d20 — on a 1 the amphora shatters, releasing a 6th-level Flame Strike centered on the holder.

Scutum Immortale

Very Rare · Shield (requires attunement)

It has turned blows that should have been fatal. The dents are still there.

- +2 to AC.
- Once per long rest, reaction when you or an ally within 5 feet takes damage: reduce it by 3d10 + CON modifier.
- Shield proficiency not required to attune.

Tessera of Passage

Common · Wondrous Item

A clay token. In the right hands, worth more than armor.

- When you present this to a humanoid that would be hostile to you, they make WIS save (DC 10) or pause and hear you out for 1 round before attacking. No effect on creatures that cannot understand language.

Toga Praetexta

Uncommon · Wondrous Item

White wool with the purple border of a magistrate. Its authority outlasts whoever is wearing it.

- Once per long rest, reaction when a hostile creature targets you: it makes WIS save (DC 13) or retargets a random adjacent creature instead.
- Advantage on Persuasion checks with Rhovian-aligned factions.

FEATS

Legionary Discipline

You trained in Rhovian military formation.

- Proficiency with shields and heavy armor.
- While adjacent to at least one ally, gain +1 AC and advantage on saves against being frightened.
- When you use the Help action, the target also gains +1 AC until the start of your next turn.

Gladiator's Blood

You survived the sands. Most don't.

- +1 CON (max 20). Proficiency with nets and tridents.
- When you reduce a creature to 0 HP, gain 1d6 temporary HP.
- While grappled, deal 1d4 piercing damage to the grappler at the start of each of your turns.

Haruspex's Eye

You read signs in the world others dismiss.

- Cast Detect Magic and Augury each once per long rest without a spell slot.
- You always know when you are being observed by magical means — sense the surveillance but not the source.

Triumph

Once per long rest when you reduce a creature to 0 HP, issue a battle cry as a free action.

- All allies within 30 feet who can hear you gain temporary HP equal to your proficiency bonus and advantage on their next attack roll.
- Prerequisite: must have survived a major battle or significant victory (DM discretion).

Pax Rhoviana

You carry the weight of imperial peace in every negotiation.

- Advantage on Persuasion when negotiating with hostile or unfriendly creatures. On a success, they hear one full proposal before attacking.
- Once per long rest, cast Zone of Truth without a spell slot.

Son of Balvor

The war-god's favor is not given — it is recognized. Balvor, called Mars by the Rhovians.

- Your weapon attacks deal +1 damage.
- When you score a critical hit, the target is frightened of you until end of their next turn.
- Proficient with all martial weapons regardless of class.

Vestal's Favor

You carry the flame that doesn't go out.

- Gain the Sacred Flame cantrip, using WIS or CHA (whichever is higher).
- Once per long rest, automatically stabilize a dying creature you touch.
- Advantage on death saving throws.

Via Militaris

You've walked every road. None of them slow you down.

- Difficult terrain from natural sources never slows you.
- When you take the Dash action, move through hostile creatures' spaces without provoking opportunity attacks.
- Your travel pace never forces the group to slow.